The iron content of these ores is highly variable. If the iron content is less than 30% in an ore, it is considered to be uneconomical. Iron is mixed with fixed proportions of Manganese, Nickel, Chromium or Vanadium to make different varieties of steel.

Distribution of Iron ore

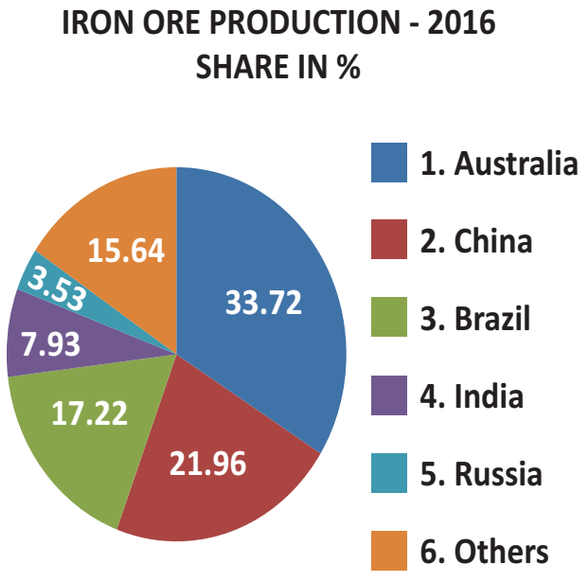
Iron - ore is unevenly distributed in the world. Good quality Iron ore is found in Australia, Brazil, Russia, China, USA, Ukraine, Canada, etc. Russia has the largest reserves of iron ore in the world.

Australia is the largest producer of Iron ore in the world. Other leading producers are China, Brazil, India and Russia. The Majority of Iron ore is (84%) produced by 5 countries alone.

Iron ore

Rank	Country	Production (Metric Ton)	Share (%)
1	Australia	531,075,350	33.72
2	China	345,841,000	21.96
3	Brazil	271,275,900	17.22
4	India	124,852,650	7.93
5	Russia	55,550,000	3.53
	Others		15.64

SOURCE: World mining data -2018



Major Iron ore fields in the world

Country	Iron ore fields
Australia	Mt. Bruce, Mt. Goldsworthy, Mt. Whaleback, etc.
China	Manchuria Region, Shandong, Sinkiang region, etc.
Brazil	Itabira in south east region.
India	Chhattisgarh and Bastar region, Odisha, Chitradurg, Kudremukh, Mayurbbanj region, etc.
Russia	Ural region, Kuzbas, Angara, etc.
U.S.A	Mesabi range, Marquette range, Cornwall, Albama, Appalachian region, etc.
Germany	Rhur basin.
Ukraine	Krivoi rog.

Manganese ore

It is a kind of Ferro-alloy used to manufacture the special quality steel. A little manganese added to iron, removes gases and acts as a 'Cleanser' in the manufacturing process. Nearly 6 Kg of manganese is used for making one ton of steel.

Manganese is used for special quality steel making; it makes steel anti - corrosive, hard and clean. It helps to increase toughness, strength and durability to resist oxidation in blast furnaces. It is used to produce alloys with Copper, Bronze, and Nickel. It is used for producing heavy machinery, tools, bleaching powder, insecticides and paints.

Distribution and production of Manganese ore

South Africa, Australia, China, Gabon, Kazakhstan, Brazil, India, Ghana, Ukraine and Mexico are the major countries possessing manganese ore. South Africa is the largest producer of manganese ore in the world, followed by Australia. The other leading manganese producers are China, Gabon and Brazil. India is the 8th largest producer of manganese in the world though it possesses the largest reserves of manganese in the world.

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